time to time, the fluctuation doesn't produce a Big Bang, it just re-creates last Tuesday—specifically, that moment when you stubbed your toe on the kitchen table and spilled an entire cup of coffee on the floor. That moment. And every other moment of your life. And everyone else's.

If this sounds like a vaguely familiar image of dystopia, it's probably because it's disturbingly similar to a nightmare thought experiment first proposed by Friedrich Nietzsche in the late 1800s. In his book *The Gay Science* he writes the following:

> *What if some day or night a demon were to steal after you into your loneliest loneliness and say to you: "This life as you now live it and have lived it, you will have to live once more and innumerable times more; and there will be nothing new in it, but every pain and every joy and every thought and sigh and everything unutterably small or great in your life will have to return to you, all in the same succession and sequence—even this spider and this moonlight between the trees, and even this moment and I myself. The eternal hourglass of existence is turned upside down again and again, and you with it, speck of dust!"*
>
> *Would you not throw yourself down and gnash your teeth and curse the demon who spoke thus? Or have you once experienced a tremendous moment when you would have answered him: "You are a god and never have I heard anything more divine." If this thought gained possession of you, it would change you as you are or perhaps crush you. The question in each and every thing, "Do you desire this once more and innumerable times more?" would lie upon your actions as the greatest weight. Or how well disposed would you have to become to yourself and to life to crave nothing more fervently than this ultimate eternal confirmation and seal?*

Heavy.

For Nietzsche, the point of this proposal had nothing to do with thermodynamics and everything to do with an examination of the meaning, purpose, and experience of life as a human being. He likely never imagined such a scenario could be *literally, physically true*, as the de Sitter Equilibrium hypothesis proposes.